Internet users in India increased eightfold from 65.3 million in May 2014 to nearly 600 million in May 2019.[18] Estimates vary on how many of these were active. Yet, most accounts agree that, by 2019, about half of India's voting population[19] now had access to information avenues that were simply not possible earlier. In early 2019, Google, for example, estimated 400 million active internet users in India, with an average of 40 million being added each year. Even more significantly, Google reported that more than half of its searches were now coming from 'Bharat', or non-metro cities. This was driven by the fact that India's average mobile data consumption per user was on par with developed markets.[20] In just four years, monthly data usage in the country increased by over twenty-nine times, rising from 0.26 GB per person in 2014 to 7.69 GB per person in 2018, by official estimates (see Figure 7.3).

Figure 7.3: India's Cheap Data Revolution through Mobiles Also Transformed Indian Politics